

The India gate: licences and label

What India requires before your bottle can be sold, who carries each piece, and how a consignment actually moves.

01 THE LICENCES · YOUR IMPORTER HOLDS THESE

FSSAI central import licence, held by the importer of record.

IEC, the import-export code, held by the importer.

NOC, per consignment, applied for by the importer on every shipment.

02 WHAT YOU PROVIDE FROM MEXICO

The proof set: a chemical analysis certificate (CoA) from an accredited laboratory, brand documents, your trademark proof, and an authorisation letter from you as brand owner. States ask for these at brand registration.

03 HOW A CONSIGNMENT MOVES

Step by step: the importer files the bill of entry, FSSAI's import system checks the consignment and label, stock moves into the bonded warehouse, the over-label is applied, and state permits release it for sale.

Where delays live: label queries at the port and state release permits. Both are paperwork problems, which means both are preventable.

04 THE LABEL · WHAT INDIA ADDS

Standard Drink declaration. FSSAI has moved to make this mandatory; carry it on your India label. The 2025 labelling amendments are the compliance baseline, enforced from 1 July 2026.

Statutory warning, in English, sized to the bottle volume; ABV declared within plus or minus 3% of actual strength. No expiry date is needed above 10% alcohol.

Kept off the label: health claims, and any nutrition panel beyond voluntary energy (kcal). The words 'non-intoxicating' are banned above 0.5% ABV.

The over-label. All India-specific elements go on a rear sticker applied at the bonded warehouse. Your original artwork does not change.

05 THE CLOCK

Importers report state label registration windows of up to four to five months in some states, and registrations align to the excise year (1 April or 1 July in several states). For the festive quarter, paperwork starts now.

THE POINT

Your importer carries the licences. You carry documents and time. Time is the one nobody can courier later.